

Data Bites: Backing up your stuff

2025-01-29

MIT Libraries Data Management Services

data-management@mit.edu

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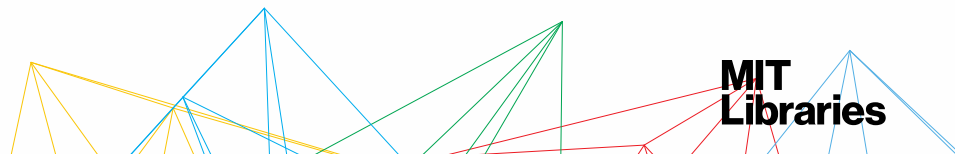
Intended learning outcomes

Attendees will be able to

- Understand what are the components of a good backup system
- Leverage MIT-provided resources for setting up their own backup systems & practices

For more information on what are Intended Learning Outcomes and why we include them, see

<https://tll.mit.edu/help/intended-learning-outcomes>.



Ask questions

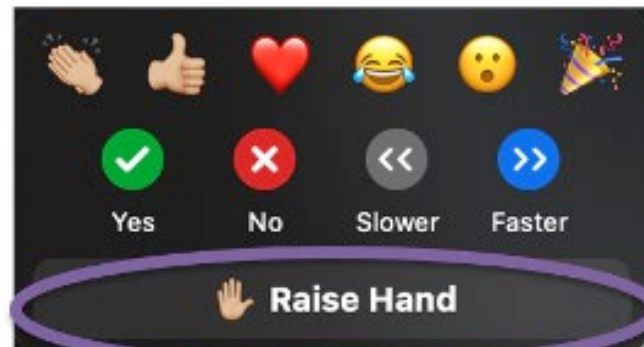
Ask questions by either

- a) typing them in the **Zoom chat window**, or
- b) use the **Raise Hand** option under the **Reactions icon** at the bottom of your Zoom window.



a) Zoom chat

b) Access the Raise Hand option by clicking the Reactions icon



Data Management Services @ MIT Libraries

Workshops

- Upcoming Classes & Events: <https://libraries.mit.edu/news/events/>
- Jan. 29 1:30pm – 2pm – Data Bite: Finding a data repository
- Jan. 31 11am – 12pm – Managing your machine learning data

Web guide

- <http://libraries.mit.edu/data-management>

Consultations (individual or research groups)

- includes help with creating data management plans, setting up file organization, finding data repositories, etc.

Contact: data-management@mit.edu

CASH REWARD

for returning my lost backpack



303 Adventure.com

- Black [AK] Burton Rucksack
- Lost on Friday 15. July at 8 pm in the Pantons Arms pub 43, Pantons St. Cambridge
- Containing a laptop (white MacBook), a black external hard drive and scientific research documents

The external hard drive is VERY important to me as it contains 5 years of research data which are crucial for my PhD thesis!!!

If you found it, I would be extremely grateful if you could return it to the Pantons Arms or contact me on: 07804430054 (ar456@cam.ac.uk)

Thank you!!

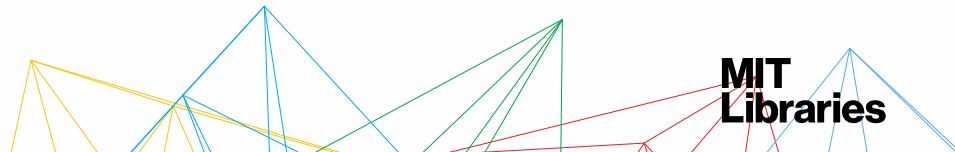
FOR MY LOST LAPTOP

I am a Rutgers Chemistry 5th year PhD student. On April 19th afternoon, my LENOVO THINKPAD T420S laptop was stolen from room 203 of Wright-Rieman building. If you stole my laptop and now you are reading this letter, I would like to say that you can keep the computer and I would like to pay you money for my data under D drive. The data is my FIVE-YEAR work. I really need the data under the D drive, there is a folder named RESEARCH, under RESEARCH folder, there is a THESIS folder. I only need that folder for my thesis defense, which is coming very soon. I would like to pay you \$1000 and use whatever way you offer to send you the money. The price is negotiable. My laptop password is 850713zd, my email address is [REDACTED] and phone number is [REDACTED]. PLEASE contact me and I would appreciate it so so much!!!

Have more than one copy

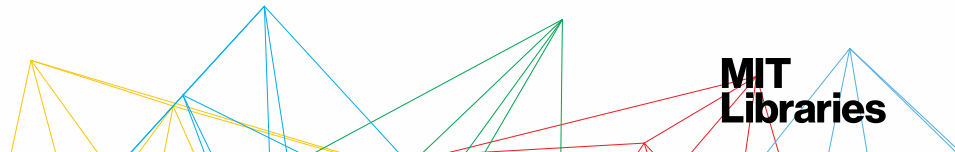
There are a number of related strategies for how many and what types of backups to have, all revolving around the number 3.

- 3-2-1
- Hear, Near, Far



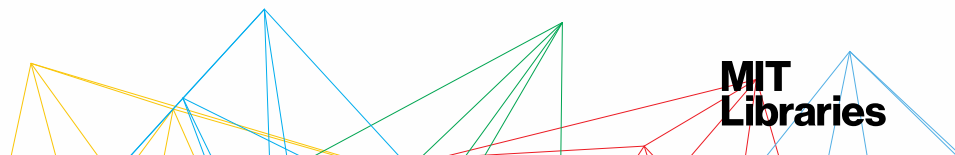
3-2-1 back up strategy

- **3** copies of data
- **2** different media
- **1** copy off-site



Here + Near + Far = 3 copies

- Here** **local/working copy**
example: on your workstation or in shared workspace
- Near** **other local/external copy or in a remote location**
example: external hard drive*
(CDs / DVDs not built to last)
- Far** **remote copy**
example: on MIT's CrashPlan service or via private companies in "cloud"



because...

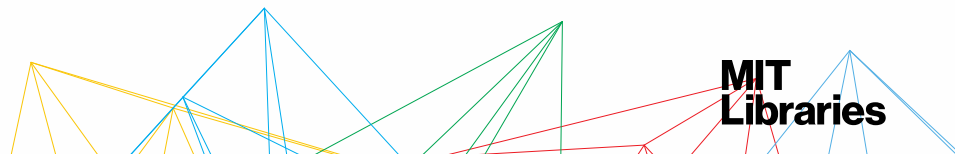


Long-term planning

Set schedule for backups if not automatic

Test file recovery at setup and on a regular schedule

Back up are not publishing or sharing, and storage $\neq$ archiving



Here + Near + Far (example 1)



<https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File%3ADesktop-PC.svg>

Here

lab computer



Near

portable hard drive

(stored in fireproof
box offsite)



Far

MIT's CrashPlan

(on lab computer)

CrashPlan (formerly Code42)

Resources:

- [IS&T CrashPlan Set Up Documentation](#)
- [IS&T Knowledgebase on CrashPlan](#)

To set up CrashPlan you need a Kerberos username & password.

What about lab/department computers that have multiple users?

- IS&T can help set up a CrashPlan service account
- Contact: servicedesk@mit.edu or 617-253-1101 (3-1101)



Here + Near + Far (example 2)



<https://pixabay.com/p-310098/> CC0



Here

laptop

Near

Dropbox

(local files sync'd to
Dropbox for business)

Far

MIT's CrashPlan

(on laptop)

Dropbox



Resources:

- [Dropbox at MIT](#)
- [IS&T Knowledgebase page, Dropbox](#)

Dropbox considerations:

- IS&T KB
 - ["Security Considerations for Cloud Storage"](#)
 - ["What happens to my Dropbox Enterprise account when I leave MIT?"](#)
- [Dropbox Quota FAQ](#)
- [Setup desktop and mobile apps](#)

OneDrive



Resources:

- [OneDrive at MIT](#)
- [IS&T Knowledgebase page, OneDrive](#)

OneDrive considerations:

- IS&T support for OneDrive seems minimal
- IS&T KB ["Security Considerations for Cloud Storage"](#)
- [OneDrive Quota Checking](#)
- [Get Desktop client and Mobile apps](#)

GoogleDrive



Resources:

- [Google Workspace for Education @ MIT](#)

GoogleDrive Considerations

- No longer unlimited storage
 - Currently 500GB for Students, Faculty, and Staff
 - 100GB for approved affiliates
- IS&T KB [“What happens to my data on Google Drive when I leave MIT”](#)
- Touchstone not integrated but accounts must map to existing MIT user accounts
- [Use GoogleDrive for Desktop](#)

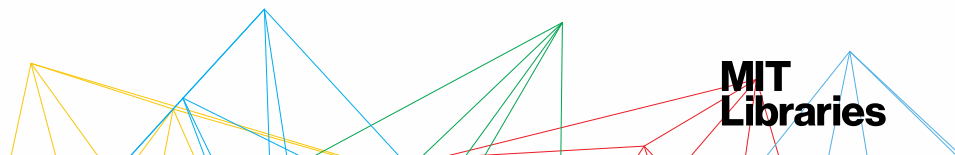
Additional data storage resources

Resources:

- [MIT Data Storage and Collaboration Options](#)
(includes individual & group/team enterprise solutions)
- [MIT hosted storage on IS&T managed servers](#)
- Leaving MIT - [what happens to your MIT accounts and services](#)

Doing active work: back it up!

- Who has access to the backups?
- Who is responsible for checking them?
How often?
- When you are ready to share, consider data repositories.



Questions?

If you have questions later,
contact: data-management@mit.edu